



Dave Keller

design engineer / lead product designer

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Portfolio: kidastro | linkedin/dkells

HIGHLIGHTS

- + 15+ years leading design at early-stage startups — from 0 to 1 through 2.0 and GTM. Across AI, data science, entertainment, messaging, ecommerce, and fintech.
- + A pixel-perfect designer who ships in code. Sweating the visual details — prototyping end-to-end flows and refining high-fidelity production UIs directly in the front-end.
- + Process builder and systems architect. Architected multi-platform design systems. Built a process that organized a ~45-developer company into four cross-functional teams shipping on a steady cadence.
- + Track record. 40+ products across web, iOS, and Android — including a #1 Paid iPhone app and a platform that grossed \$33M in year one.
- + Founder & client services. Co-founded a 20-person design/dev agency and a \$3M-funded messaging app. The agency became a concepting and prototyping shop for Warner Bros — with work for Ellen, DreamWorks, and The Economist along the way.

SKILLS

- + Expert in Figma & design systems — multi-platform component libraries, prototyping, hand-off
- + Designing in front-end (prototypes to production) with Claude Code, Cursor and Tailwind
- + Comfortable writing HTML / CSS / JS and working in React / Next.js / Tailwind CSS / TypeScript
- + Fluent in GitHub — push/pull, branches, and PRs; Linear, Trello and Notion for sprint planning and docs

EXPERIENCE

Strangeworks

Oct 2023 – Present

Design Engineer / Director of Product · promoted from Senior Product Designer (Apr 2024) · Remote / Austin, TX

Lead product strategy and design at this data-science consulting company, building a suite of tools, apps, and optimization interfaces for Fortune 500 science teams running AI and quantum/HPC compute.

- + Promoted to Director of Product in 6 months. Researched internal processes and designed the vision for our workflow app Aura — hands-on from business strategy to production code
- + Embedded with engineering, leadership, and the science team to prototype and ship across our compute platform, the Aura workflow app, docs, and multiple marketing sites
- + Designed an AI-assisted app for data-science problem formulation and computation on HPC/quantum, plus dozens of client apps for optimization problems like staff scheduling and fleet vehicle routing

QuotaPath

Jan 2022 – Oct 2023

Senior Product UX/UI Designer · Hybrid / Austin, TX

Led design across multiple product teams at this Series B SaaS platform for sales commission planning and tracking.

- + Shipped platform features monthly, from comp modeling and onboarding to sandbox and payout workflows
- + Designed and launched the Compensation Hub, a commission library and modeling tool that drove \$1.5M+ in new pipeline in a year
- + Co-created a product-development process across 4 cross-functional teams and mentored the designers running it

OneAssembly

Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

Product UX/UI Design Lead · Front-End Developer · Austin, TX

Designed and built this B2B device auction platform from idea to launch in a year, grossing \$3M+ in the first beta month and \$33M+ in year one.

- + Took the product from whiteboard to production launch on a 3-person dev team
- + Designed most of it directly in code (React, Tailwind), plus the brand, marketing site, and go-to-market

BnbFinder (now Savvy.com)

May 2019 – Feb 2021

Product UX/UI Design Lead · Front-End Developer · Austin, TX

Designed and built this travel listings platform to 8K subscribers (4K+ paid) in under a year on a 3-person team.

- + Built the consumer, owner, and admin apps in Elixir and React/Next.js on a custom Tailwind framework
- + Shipped responsive front-ends across all three surfaces, demoing to stakeholders every two weeks

Phobio : Rodio

Jan 2018 – May 2019

Product UX/UI Design Lead · Austin, TX

Designed Rodio, a retail workforce communication platform. Partnered with Fortune-100 Kronos and signed MarketSource (Target/Best Buy), reaching millions of daily interactions.

- + Built Rodio's multi-platform design system (master, web, iOS, Android) and led a team of 20 to 20K+ paid users
- + Designed and pitched the demo that closed the Kronos and Form.com contracts and led to acquisition

Timebomb

Sep 2015 – Dec 2017

Co-Founder · Product UX/UI Design Lead · Austin, TX

Co-founded and designed this conditional messaging app (iOS and Android). Raised \$3M from angels including Katy Perry and Warner Bros., with a marketing partnership from Ellen.

- + Led a product team of 10 from concept to launch and 20K+ users
- + Designed the pitch decks behind the \$3M raise

Made by Rocket

Aug 2009 – Nov 2017

Co-Founder · Product Designer · Front-End Developer · Austin, TX

Co-founded and grew this agency to 20 people across 30+ projects, including a #1 Paid iPhone app and work for Ellen, Need for Speed, DreamWorks, and The Economist. Became an ideation and prototyping lab for Warner Bros.

- + Designed and shipped A Beautiful Mess, a photo editing app that hit #1 Paid on the App Store and held top-100 for over a year
- + Designed and prototyped apps for 30+ clients, from Ellen and DreamWorks to early-stage startups

INTERESTS

Guitar and vocals in a rock/metal band · Recording and mixing in Logic Pro · Mountain biking and dirt bike racing · Video editing in Final Cut Pro · Indoor soccer and racquetball · International travel (fluent in Spanish)

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

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| + Figma / Photoshop | + Git / GitHub | + design systems / component libraries |
| + Claude Code / Codex / Cursor | + Data Viz and Animation libraries | + Linear / Notion |
| + React / Next.js | + Recharts / D3 / OpenMaps | + iOS / Android / VR |
| + HTML / CSS / Tailwind CSS | + React Flow / Framer Motion | + Framer / Webflow |
| + JavaScript / TypeScript | + Marketing sites | + Agile / design sprints |